

IELTS Writing: Paraphrasing Pack

Book 11 · Rewrite the question clearly without copying

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Part of the Stratum IELTS Writing Guide Series

Who this book is for

You understand the question, but your introduction starts by **copying half of it**.
Or you change words so hard that the meaning breaks.

This pack trains safe paraphrasing for Task 2 intros (and useful Task 1 openers).

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1. What paraphrasing is (and is not)
 2. Four safe methods
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1. What paraphrasing is (and is not)

Is: same meaning, different wording/structure.

Is not: synonym spam that changes the idea.

Is not: copying the question with two words swapped.

Examiners accept some topic-word repetition. Clarity > fancy synonyms.

2. Four safe methods

Use 2 methods together.

Method A — Synonyms (careful)

children → *young people* / *pupils* (context matters)

important → *significant* / *essential*

think → *believe* / *argue*

Method B — Word form

develop → *development*

pollute → *pollution*

educate → *education*

Method C — Structure flip

Active ↔ passive; clause order change.

Governments should fund arts. → *Arts funding should come from governments.*

Method D — Broad → precise paraphrase

Keep exact task meaning.

If the question says *unpaid community service in high schools*, do not write only *volunteer work for people*.

3. Mini change banks

Common prompt word	Safer alternatives
people say / some people think	some argue / it is believed
nowadays	today / in many countries
advantages	benefits / positive effects
disadvantages	drawbacks / downsides
problem	issue / challenge
solution	measure / practical step
children	young people / teenagers (if age fits)
government	authorities / the state
technology	digital tools / modern technology

Avoid random thesaurus words you cannot control.

4. Before / after lab

Prompt: Some people think unpaid community service should be a compulsory part of high school programmes. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Weak copy

Some people think unpaid community service should be a compulsory part of high school programmes. I agree...

Better paraphrase

It is sometimes argued that secondary-school students should be required to do unpaid community work. I largely agree...

Prompt: Do the advantages of online shopping outweigh the disadvantages?

Better intro start

Online shopping has become common worldwide. Although there are clear drawbacks, I believe the advantages outweigh them because...

5. Practice set

Paraphrase each prompt in 1–2 sentences (position optional).

1. University education should be free for everyone.
2. Children should start learning a foreign language in primary school.
3. Increasing fuel prices is the best way to reduce traffic.
4. Many people prefer to shop online rather than in physical stores.
5. Governments should spend more on public parks than on roads.

Then write full intros and check at <https://stratumielts.com>.

6. Next step

Pair with **Book 8 (Template Trap)** so paraphrasing does not become a new memorised script. If ideas fail after a good intro, use **Book 7**.

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End of Book 11 — Paraphrasing Pack